10. After the dawn of the era of coalition politics, the regional parties have assumed an important role in national politics. They have joined the coalition governments formed at the centre and shared power with the national parties.

DYSFUNCTIONS

However, there are also negative points in the role of regional parties. These are as follows:

1. They have given more importance to regional interests rather than national interests. They have neglected the implications and consequences of their narrow approach to the resolution of national issues.

2. They have encouraged regionalism, casteism, linguism, communalism and tribalism which have become hurdles to national integration.

3. They are responsible for the unresolution of the inter-state water disputes, inter-state border disputes and other inter-state issues.

4. They have also indulged in corruption, nepotism, favouritism and other forms of misutilisation of power in order to promote their self-interest.

5. They have focused more on the populist schemes and measures to expand and strengthen their electoral base. This has adversely affected the state economy and development.

6. They bring in regional factors in the decision-making and the policy-making by the coalition government at the centre. They force the central leadership to yield to their demands.

[1]Observation made by Stanley A. Kochnock in Ram Reddy, G. and Sharma, B.A.V., *Regionalism in India – A Study of Telangana*, Concept Publishers, New Delhi, 1979, pp. 87–88.

[2]Brass, P.R., *The Politics of India Since Independence*, Second Edition, Cambridge University Press, Cambridge, UK, 1993, p. 89.

[3]Bombwall, K.R., Regional parties in Indian politics: A preview. In Bhatnagar, S. and Kumar, P. (Eds) *Regional Political Parties in India*, ESS Publications, Delhi, 1988, pp. 1–16.

[4]*Ibid.*

[5]*Ibid.*

[6]*Siwach, J.R., Dynamics of Indian Government and Politics, Second Edition, Sterling Publishers Private Limited, New Delhi, 1990, p. 865.*

[7]*Ibid.*

[8]*Ibid.*